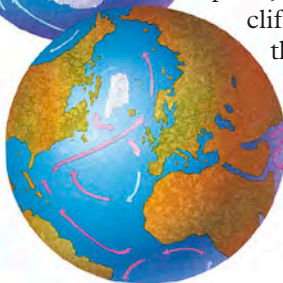




OCEANS



With oceans and seas making up 71 percent of the Earth's surface, more than two-thirds of our planet is covered with water. Beneath the waves lies a fascinating landscape. Much of the ocean floor is a vast plain, but there are also trenches, cliffs, and mountains, all larger than any found on dry land.

Ocean currents

These show the directions in which water flows.

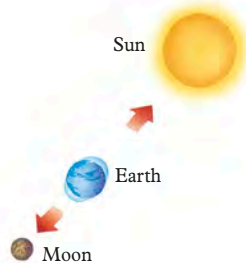
 Cold currents

 Warm currents

Underwater canyons are cut by currents flowing over the seabed like rivers.

These underwater islands are called guyots.

Trenches can be deeper than the highest mountains on land.



Ebbing and flowing

Tides are made by the sun and moon pulling on the oceans. When the sun, Earth, and moon are in a line, there are large spring tides.

